

RUN-004 - Shared Mailbox Provisioning (M365)

Purpose

Step-by-step procedure for creating a new Microsoft 365 shared mailbox and configuring member access for a Summit IT team or department. Shared mailboxes do not require an M365 license as long as the mailbox is under 50 GB. This runbook also covers adding/removing members from existing shared mailboxes.

Prerequisites / Access Needed

Requirement	Details
Approved REQ ticket	Submitted by a manager or department head via https://help.summitit.com
M365 Admin Center access	Role: Exchange Administrator or Global Administrator
Okta Admin Console	May be needed to verify requester identity and licensing
SummitDesk admin access	To update and close the REQ ticket

Required Information (From Service Request)

Field	Example
Desired email address	support@summitit.com
Display name	Summit Support Team
Department / owner	IT - Service Desk / Linda Park
Members (UPNs)	linda.park@summitit.com, carlos.whitfield@summitit.com
Send As permission needed?	Yes
Send on Behalf needed?	No

Forwarding required?	No
Alias addresses	helpdesk@summitit.com (secondary alias)
Storage estimate	Standard (<50 GB)

Procedure

1. Validate the Request

1. Open the REQ ticket in SummitDesk.
2. Confirm the request is from a manager or department head (L1 cannot create shared mailboxes without manager authorization).
3. Check that the desired email address does not conflict with an existing mailbox, alias, or distribution list:
- M365 Admin Center > **Groups** > search for the proposed address. - Also check **Users > Active Users** and **Deleted Users**.
4. If there is a conflict, comment on the ticket and request an alternative address before proceeding.

2. Create the Shared Mailbox

Via M365 Admin Center (preferred for L1/L2):

1. Navigate to <https://admin.microsoft.com>.
2. Go to **Teams & groups > Shared mailboxes**.
3. Click **+ Add a shared mailbox**.
4. Fill in:

Field	Value
Name (display name)	Summit Support Team
Email address	support@summitit.com

5. Click **Save**.
6. The mailbox is created. You will be directed to the mailbox settings page - keep this open for next steps.

Via Exchange Online PowerShell (for advanced scenarios or bulk creation):

```
Connect-ExchangeOnline -UserPrincipalName admin@summitit.com
New-Mailbox -Shared -Name "Summit Support Team" -DisplayName "Summit Support Team" -Alias "supp
```

3. Add Members (Full Access Permission)

Full Access allows members to open and read the shared mailbox. It does **not** automatically grant Send As.

Via Admin Center: 1. On the shared mailbox settings page > **Members section > Customize permissions**. 2. Click **Edit** next to **Read and manage (Full Access)**. 3. Click **+ Add members** and search for each member's UPN. 4. Add all members listed in the ticket. Click **Save**.

Via PowerShell:

```
Add-MailboxPermission -Identity "support@summitit.com" -User "linda.park@summitit.com" -AccessRights FullControl
```

The `-AutoMapping $true` flag causes the shared mailbox to appear automatically in the member's Outlook. Set to `$false` if the requester does not want automapping.

4. Grant Send As Permission (If Requested)

Send As allows members to send email appearing to come from the shared mailbox address rather than their personal UPN.

Via Admin Center: 1. On the shared mailbox settings page > **Members > Customize permissions**. 2. Click **Edit** next to **Send as**. 3. Add all members who need Send As. Click **Save**.

Via PowerShell:

```
Add-RecipientPermission -Identity "support@summitit.com" -Trustee "linda.park@summitit.com" -AccessRights SendAs
```

5. Grant Send on Behalf Permission (If Requested)

Send on Behalf causes emails to show as "From: [Member Name] on behalf of Summit Support Team."

Via PowerShell:

```
Set-Mailbox -Identity "support@summitit.com" -GrantSendOnBehalfTo "carlos.whitfield@summitit.com"
```

To add multiple delegates:

```
Set-Mailbox -Identity "support@summitit.com" -GrantSendOnBehalfTo @{Add="carlos.whitfield@summitit.com"; Add="linda.park@summitit.com"}
```

6. Add Email Aliases (If Requested)

1. In M365 Admin Center > **Teams & groups > Shared mailboxes** > select the mailbox.
2. Click **Edit** on the **Email aliases** section.
3. Click **+ Add an alias** and enter the additional address (e.g., `helpdesk@summitit.com`).
4. Save.

Via PowerShell:

```
Set-Mailbox -Identity "support@summitit.com" -EmailAddresses @{Add="helpdesk@summitit.com"}
```

7. Configure Automapping (If Override Needed)

Automapping is on by default (shared mailbox appears in Outlook automatically). If any member requests no automapping:

```
# Remove existing Full Access and re-add without automapping
Remove-MailboxPermission -Identity "support@summitit.com" -User "carlos.whitfield@summitit.com"
Add-MailboxPermission -Identity "support@summitit.com" -User "carlos.whitfield@summitit.com" -A
```

8. Verify Mailbox Replication (Allow 30-60 Minutes)

New shared mailboxes can take 30-60 minutes to fully replicate across Exchange Online. Advise the requester accordingly.

To verify the mailbox is accessible: 1. Wait 30 minutes. 2. Log into <https://outlook.office.com> as one of the members. 3. Click the profile icon (top right) > **Open another mailbox**. 4. Type support@summitit.com and click **Open**. The shared mailbox inbox should open in a new tab.

9. Notify the Requester

Reply to the REQ ticket and send the following to the requesting manager:

```
Subject: Shared Mailbox Ready - support@summitit.com

Hi [Manager Name],

Your shared mailbox has been created and is ready to use.

Email address:  support@summitit.com
Display name:   Summit Support Team
Aliases:        helpdesk@summitit.com
Members:        linda.park, carlos.whitfield
Permissions:    Full Access + Send As

Members can access the mailbox in Outlook via:
File > Open & Export > Other User's Folder
- or it may appear automatically in their Outlook left panel.

Allow up to 60 minutes for full replication.

If you need to add/remove members, submit a new request at https://help.summitit.com.

Summit IT Service Desk - Ticket [REQ-#####]
```

10. Document and Close the Ticket

1. Record in the ticket: mailbox address, display name, members, permissions granted, aliases, date created.
2. Set ticket status to **Resolved**.
3. Category: Microsoft 365 / Sub-category: Shared Mailbox.

Adding or Removing Members from an Existing Shared Mailbox

Add a Member

1. M365 Admin Center > **Teams & groups** > **Shared mailboxes** > select the mailbox.
2. Under Members > **Read and manage** > **+ Add members** > enter UPN > Save.
3. Repeat for Send As if required.

Remove a Member

1. M365 Admin Center > **Teams & groups** > **Shared mailboxes** > select the mailbox.
2. Under Members > **Read and manage** > select the member > **Remove** > Save.
3. Also remove from **Send As / Send on Behalf** if applicable.

Verification

Check	Expected Result
Shared mailbox appears in M365 Admin	Yes, under Teams & groups > Shared mailboxes
Members can open mailbox in Outlook	Shared mailbox visible or accessible via Open Another Mailbox
Send As works	Test email sent from shared address - appears from shared address in recipient's inbox
Aliases resolve correctly	Email to alias address is received in the shared mailbox
No M365 license assigned	Shared mailbox should not consume a paid license (verify in Admin Center)

Rollback / If It Fails

Symptom	Action
Address conflict - "email address already exists"	Check all recipients (mailboxes, groups, contacts) for conflict; propose alternate address
Members not seeing mailbox in Outlook	Allow 60 minutes; check Full Access permission is set; run Outlook repair if needed
Send As email showing personal address instead of shared	Verify Send As permission is granted (not just Full Access); may take up to 60 min to replicate

Mailbox over 50 GB warning	Shared mailboxes over 50 GB require an Exchange Online Plan 2 license or M365 E3 assigned to the shared mailbox - escalate to L2/M365 team
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Escalation

Condition	Escalate To	Contact
Mailbox size >50 GB or licensing question	L2 - M365 team	m365@summitit.com
PowerShell errors / Exchange Online connectivity issues	L2 - M365 team	m365@summitit.com
External email alias (non-summitit.com domain)	L3 - Infrastructure	infra@summitit.com
Compliance/legal hold requirements on mailbox	L3 + Compliance team	compliance@summitit.com